DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

NAME: RIDDHI GUPTA

REG NO.: 25BSA10042

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INTRODUCTION

This project has helped to develop some of the essential digital literacy skills that are vital today in a modern technology based world. Being a digital ambassador for the school the aim of this project was to create awareness among fellow students about the use of digital tools and platforms.

This project has been divided into different modules each of which has covered a specific aspect of digital learning. These areas of digital learning are learning about digital concepts, creating a professional online presence, learning about coding and teamworking through digital platforms, learning about effective email communication and learning about cybercrime and online safety. During this project, experience was gained by using platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, HackerRank, and Google Forms.

In Conclusion-

This project has helped to develop technical skills, communication skills, and awareness about online safety. It has also emphasized the need to be responsible, cautious and professional while dealing with digital platforms.

TASK-1

Project Report: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I created a comprehensive one-page infographic titled "Digital Literacy for Students" using the design platform Canva. The primary reason I chose to use Canva is because of its wide variety of templates and the easy-to-use drag-and drop functionality allowed me to build an effective, professionally-designed product that represents what it means to be a Student Digital Ambassador.

The infographic is broken up into five themes encompassing a complete picture of what it means to be a good digital citizen. I defined Digital Literacy presented Safe Internet Practices (such as using Two Factor Authentication), emphasized the importance of maintaining a Professional Presence on the Internet provided Actionable Tips for Email Etiquette and introduced Helpful Digital Tools (e.g., Google Workspace, AI Assistants) to enhance academic productivity. I utilized a dark blue and white color scheme for the design giving it an authoritative and trustworthy feel while presenting data clearly and in an accessible manner for my peers.

During the construction of the infographic, I learned about the concept of "Information Hierarchy" and had to determine what bits of information were most important for students to know and how to condense large pieces of information into brief but impactful statements. Additionally, arranging the text blocks with corresponding visual icons taught me how to use images effectively to communicate information.

By Riddhi Gupta- Student Digital Ambassador

Digital Literacy for Students

Essential skills for navigating the digital world safely and professionally.

01 What is Digital Literacy?

It is the ability to find, evaluate, and share information clearly through various digital platforms.

02 Safe Internet Practices

Protect yourself by using strong passwords, enabling 2FA, and avoiding suspicious links or downloads.

03 Professional Presence

Curate a positive digital footprint. Use professional photos and keep social media accounts "clean" for future employers.

04 Email Etiquette

Use clear subject lines, formal greetings, and professional language when communicating with teachers or peers.

05 Useful Digital Tools

Master tools like Google Workspace, Canva, and AI assistants to boost your academic productivity and collaboration.

TASK 2

Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

I created a basic presence on three major platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These three platforms represent the essential elements of a professional online presence.

GitHub is where I plan to host all of my coding projects. These projects range from academic exercises to personal projects. By creating a profile README file, I have made sure that anyone who visits my profile will see a customized bio with my name, branch, year, and a statement of intent to increase my knowledge of opensource software development. In the coming four years, I plan to use GitHub to contribute to opensource projects, work on hackathon projects with other people, and build a rich collection of code that demonstrates my capabilities to future employers.

LinkedIn is considered the default platform for professional networking. I have ensured my LinkedIn account is complete by adding a detailed Education section, including information on my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. In the next four years, my plan for LinkedIn is to utilize it not only for job searching but to develop a professional network. I plan on connecting with seniors, professors, and industry leaders, posting updates on my academic projects, and engaging with relevant content on the platform to establish a professional online presence.

Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning competitions. I have selected this platform because I want to supplement my academic learning with hands-on experience. Although I am a beginner on this platform, my plan for using Kaggle in the next few years is to utilize it as a resource for learning from other users' notebooks and competing in beginner competitions, which will be helpful for developing analytical skills, a necessity for success in today's tech-savvy environment.

Together, these three platforms form a comprehensive digital portfolio that will evolve alongside my academic and professional growth.

TASK-3

Exploring Coding and Collaboration Platforms

My investigation into coding and collaboration sites was done with the use of both HackerRank and Google Forms. Using these websites it has allowed me to learn how to practice programming as well as create interactive learning content for other people. Building my account on HackerRank as well as completing a beginner problem that has helped me develop not only my programming capabilities but also my logical reasoning skills.

There are a variety of coding problems available through HackerRank that break down each coding step and allow me to gain confidence before attempting more complex code problems to tackle on the site. I want to work on HackerRank regularly to help build my problem-solving abilities and Google Forms allows me to create a digital literacy awareness quiz in both multiple choice and opened formats that would test fundamentals of digital literacy, as well as allow me to collect and analyze results from those who completed it.

Google Forms is excellent for collecting data from people for a variety of reasons; types of tests may range from quiz-style, surveystyle or even academic based. Both HackerRank and Google Forms will assist in my academic development by improving my coding proficiency and allowing me to develop interactive types of educational material. In addition I will continue to use both of these platforms moving forward to help expand my knowledge and help me work more productively.

Task 4

Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

In this task I used a document editor to write two professional emails. One email was to request an extension of an assignment and the other was to request an internship. I focused my attention on writing good subject lines and greetings to ensure that the emails I wrote were professional and efficient. I also came up with a checklist of good social media usage to assist my fellow students in ensuring that they have a good online footprint.

However, I encountered a problem with digital communication in my class and One of my colleagues sent a very short and blunt message to our group chat without a greeting.

This results in misunderstandings and the impression that he was angry and demanding. This resulted in a major argument with my colleague and a two-day delay in the submission of our assignment. To avoid this situation the student should have used a friendly greeting and been clear with his intentions. This situation has also taught me that without visual cues, the choice of words and their tone are very important in digital communication.

TASK 5

Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention Guide

During the course of researching this topic I was surprised to find the ways by which the perpetrators of cybercrime exploit the emotions of the people instead of their intelligence. For example, the nature of the scams was such that it exploited the emotions of the people such as “getting job opportunities,” “winning prizes,” “getting messages from the bank,” and so on which prompted the people to act impulsively without verifying the authenticity of the messages.

Moreover, the discovery of UPI-related scams was particularly worrying for me especially because I have observed that people are losing money only because they approve the payment requests thinking they are getting money. Therefore, from this experience I have come to the conclusion that even a small lack of knowledge can lead to major problems.

Based on this experience, I have concluded that in the future, I will not act impulsively in responding to the messages that I get online. In addition, I will take some time to check the links that I get online. In addition, I will not disclose any sensitive information online. In addition, I will ensure that the passwords that I use for the accounts that I create online are strong.

CONCLUSION

This project has given me a clear idea of what digital literacy is and how it is important in today's technology based world. Through the different tasks I have learned different aspects of digital literacy such as creating information content, creating a professional online presence and using digital technology for learning and working together and developing communication etiquette. In addition, I have learned more about cybercrime and the precautions that need to be taken in order to ensure safety while using the internet.

Through the completion of this project. I have enhanced my technical, creative and communication skills by this. In addition I have learned the importance of being careful, responsible while using digital technology. I have learned the ways of presenting the information effectively and how to be professional.

This was a valuable learning experience for me which enhanced my confidence and prepared me for using digital technology safely efficiently and responsibly in the future.

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